lessened. Ultimately the forces that stayed behind worked with the Shan insurgents and dealt mostly in the drug trade for the next several decades. They did not pose a serious threat to Ne Win's regime.

Internally the Revolutionary Council granted a blanket amnesty to anyone willing to lay down his or her arms. Initial talks held with multiple insurgent groups bore little fruit. Following the communist implosion of the late 1960s, the Burmese authorities had to contend with a Shan insurgency on the border with Thailand. The growing drug trade in the notorious Golden Triangle of Southeast Asia may explain the growth of this movement. The geographic isolation of the region and the logistical difficulties of formulating a logical counterinsurgency campaign worsened the problem. Attempts to form local militias to combat the insurgents were disastrous, as groups such at the Ka Kwe Ye were driven only by the goal of maximizing profits. The massive corruption within the region triggered by the lucrative profits from the drug trade help to explain the longevity of this movement.

The most successful attempt at forging an antigovernment insurgency was the National Democratic Front (NDF) formed in 1974. Included in this coalition were the Karen National Union, as well as the Arakan, Kachin, and Kayan insurgency factions. As with earlier coalitions, the NDF was beset with a lack of coordination as well as the absence of external support. The movement did agree to a common goal of a federal system unlike earlier attempts to create independent nation-states, which was unrealistic at this time.

The Karens were the main faction member and were unable to sustain any momentum. Tacit support from Thailand ended by the late 1970s. Furthermore, the Burmese military launched successful incursions against the Karen's during the mid-1980s. Not only did this offensive hurt the military strength of the Karens, but it also economically cut off the group from essential revenues near the border.

ECONOMIC POLICY 1962–1988

Unquestionably the most significant internal rife in Burma during the Ne Win regime was in dealing with economic policy. Aung Gyi, who had organized the economic restructuring during the caretaker period, was